



**COMBINED MANUAL
DESCRIPTION OF CHANGES ATTACHMENT
REVISED SECTIONS – ISSUED 10/2025**

DRAFT

PROPOSED CHANGES

The EFFECTIVE DATE of the changes is the same as the issuance date unless stated otherwise.

0013.03.09 (MFIP Housing Assistance Grant) in MFIP, updates made to the MFIP housing grant amount.

0018.15 (Shelter Deductions) in SNAP, updates made to the maximum shelter costs and the homeless shelter deduction.

0018.15.09 (Utility Deductions) in SNAP, updates made to the Heat/Air Standard Utility Deduction, electric standard utility deduction, and the phone standard utility deduction.

0018.21 (Standard Disregard) in SNAP, updates made to the standard deduction amounts.

0019.06 (Gross Income Limits) in SNAP, updates made to the income limits for 130% and 200% of Federal Poverty Guidelines.

0019.09 (GIT for Separate Elderly Disabled Units) in SNAP, updates the GIT for separate elderly disabled units due to COLA.

0020.09 (MFIP/DWP Assistance Standards) in MFIP, updates the Family Wage Level and the Transitional Standard.

0020.12 (SNAP Assistance Standards) in SNAP, updates made to the Monthly Assistance Standards.

0020.18 (GA Assistance Standards) The assistance standard for GA recipients living in the community increases to \$360.50 effective 10/1/2025.

0022.12.01 (How to Calculate Benefits Level – SNAP/MSA/GRH) in SNAP, updates the Thrifty Food Plan Values and the Minimum SNAP Allotment.

0023.12 (Special Diets) updates the MSA Special Diets amounts

MFIP:

To be eligible for the **\$117** MFIP Housing Grant, an assistance unit:

- Must meet all MFIP financial and non-financial eligibility factors.
- Must not be an assistance unit with a relative caregiver who opted out of MFIP assistance, or a unit in which the relative caregiver applied for MFIP as part of the assistance unit, but only the relative children were found to be eligible.
- Must not be opting out of MFIP cash portion or the MFIP Housing Grant, see [0014.03.03.03 \(Opting Out of MFIP Cash Portion\)](#).
- Must not be currently receiving a Housing subsidy through the Department of Housing and Urban Development UNLESS 1 or both of the caregivers meet 1 of the criteria below:
 - Age 60 or older.
 - Caring for another member in the assistance unit, a relative in the household, or a foster child in the household due to illness or incapacity certified by a qualified professional which is expected to continue for 31 days or more.
 - Caregiver is certified by a qualified professional to be suffering from an illness, injury or incapacity that is expected to continue for more than 30 days, and severely limits the caregiver's ability to work 20 or more hours per week.
 - Meets Special Medical Criteria (SMC).
 - Receives Supplemental Security Income (SSI).
 - Receives Mille Lacs Tribal TANF.

There is no proration for the MFIP Housing Assistance Grant. If an assistance unit is eligible 1 day in the month, there is eligibility for the full MFIP Housing Assistance Grant.

Eligibility for the MFIP Housing Assistance Grant is determined prospectively.

Suspended MFIP cases or MFIP cases that receive a food portion only grant continue to receive the MFIP Housing Assistance Grant. Receipt of the MFIP Housing Assistance Grant counts towards the 60 month time limit. For those caregivers who are subject to the TANF time limit, see [0011.30 \(60-Month Lifetime Limit\)](#).

MFIP units that choose to opt out of the cash portion of MFIP must also opt out of the MFIP Housing Assistance Grant. Suspended MFIP units or MFIP units that receive a food portion only grant, may choose to opt out of the MFIP Housing Assistance Grant.

The MFIP Housing Assistance Grant is not subject to sanction. When the 10% or 30% sanction policy is applied to the MFIP cash, the MFIP Housing Assistance Grant is not affected. When a vendor is in place for a sanction, the MFIP Housing Assistance Grant is not required to be vendored as part of the sanction policy. If a case closes for a 100% sanction, the MFIP Housing Assistance Grant benefit will also be closed as part of the MFIP closure.

There is no recoupment from the MFIP Housing Assistance Grant for cash, food or Housing Assistance claims.

Only 2 types of mandatory vendoring apply to the MFIP Housing Assistance Grant:

- Drug felon offenses, see [0011.27.03 \(Drug Felons\)](#).
- Money mismanagement, see [0024.09 \(Protective and Vendor Payments\)](#).

For reporting requirements, verification requirements and voluntary vendoring, follow MFIP in [0007 \(Reporting\)](#), [0010.18.01](#)

[\(Mandatory Verifications - Cash Assistance\)](#), [0024.09 \(Protective and Vendor Payments\)](#).

DWP, SNAP, MSA, GA, GRH:

No provisions.

MFIP, MSA, GA, GRH:

No provisions.

DWP:

Use family maintenance needs, see [0002.23 \(Glossary: Fair Hearing...\)](#), along with personal needs allowances, see [0002.49 \(Glossary: Permanent...\)](#) and countable income to determine the DWP grant. For more information on how to calculate a benefit level for MFIP/DWP/GA, see [0022.12 \(How to Calc. Benefit Level - MFIP/DWP/GA\)](#).

SNAP:

Shelter Deductions consist of housing and utility costs. Allow verified housing costs in the month billed, or if not billed, when they first become payable. For self-employed persons claiming housing costs as a business expense, also allow the expense as a shelter deduction following the provisions below. For utility costs, see [0018.15.09 \(Utility Deductions\)](#). For verification of shelter deductions, see [0010.18.02.03 \(Non-Mandatory Verifications – SNAP\)](#).

Allowable Housing Costs

Deduct continuing housing costs only if the unit must pay someone outside their SNAP assistance unit for the expense. Payments for past due housing expenses are not allowed as a deduction.

The most common examples of allowable housing costs are listed below. However, this is not an all-inclusive list:

- Rent, including mobile home lot rent. When units pay their housing costs on a monthly basis, but pay this in advance for multiple months at a time, they are allowed a shelter deduction for the period the advanced payments are intended to cover.
 - Rent on a garage if the garage rental is a condition of renting the apartment.
 - Homeowner's insurance
 - When paid through a mortgage escrow account, allow the entire amount of the monthly homeowners insurance expense.
 - When NOT paid through a mortgage escrow account, only allow the homeowners insurance portion paid for the structure, averaged as a monthly expense.
- See [0010.18.02.03 \(Non-Mandatory Verifications – SNAP\)](#) for how to verify homeowner's insurance.
- Mortgage insurance that is required by the lender and the cost is verified.
 - Mortgage, 2nd mortgage, or contract-for-deed payments. See MORTGAGE in [0002.43 \(Glossary: Money...\)](#).
 - Property taxes and state and local assessments.
 - When paid through a mortgage escrow account, allow the entire amount of the monthly property tax expense as billed by the mortgage lender.
 - When NOT paid through a mortgage escrow account, calculate and allow the average monthly property tax expense.
 - Condominium fees and association fees that are required to own a home.
 - Vehicle payment and insurance if the unit lives in the vehicle.
 - Room portion of charges for group residential housing or a domestic violence shelter.
 - Costs not reimbursed for repair of a home damaged or destroyed by a natural disaster.

Do NOT allow a deduction for:

- Deposits on rental properties or utilities.
- Life or auto insurance or other extra coverage on personal property added on the homeowner's property insurance policy.
- Foundation, skirting, or tie-downs for mobile homes.
- Garage rent if the garage rental is not a condition of renting the apartment.
- Home improvements.
- Down payments and closing costs.
- Renter's insurance even if required by the landlord or residential property management company.

Housing Cost Calculations

Calculate shelter deductions paid weekly, bi-weekly, monthly or semi-monthly using the multiplier. The multiplier is:

- 4.3 for weekly costs.
- 2.15 for bi-weekly (every other week) costs.
- 1 for monthly costs.
- 2 for semi-monthly costs.

Housing Costs when Units have More than 1 Residence

Housing costs may only be allowed as a deduction for one property.

In situations where clients have a home outside of Minnesota as well as Minnesota and live part of the year in the other place and part of the year in Minnesota, they may only receive a deduction for the continuing charges paid for the home they have in Minnesota. See [0011.06 \(State Residence\)](#) for more information on when someone has a home in Minnesota and another place.

Housing Costs for Ineligible Unit Members

Allow a deduction for households which contain people who are required to be in the unit but who are disqualified or do not meet technical or procedural eligibility requirements. See [0014.03.06 \(Determining the SNAP Unit\)](#). For Uncle Harry cases, see [0022.24 \(Uncle Harry Food Support Benefits\)](#).

- For units which contain ineligible non-citizens, non-applicants, unit members disqualified for non-compliance with Social Security enumeration requirements, or ineligible able-bodied adults who are responsible for housing costs:
 1. Prorate housing costs billed to or paid by the ineligible person or disqualified unit member among household members.
 2. Disregard the prorated share of the costs for the ineligible person(s) or disqualified unit member(s). Allow the remainder of the costs as a deduction for the unit.

The utility costs are not prorated. See [0018.15.09 \(Utility Deductions\)](#).

- For units which contain an ineligible student:
 - When an ineligible student pays all of the cost, the unit is not entitled to a housing or utility deduction.
 - When a unit shares housing costs, deduct ONLY the amount actually paid or contributed by the unit. If you cannot differentiate the payments or contributions:
 1. Prorate the housing cost evenly among the people actually paying or contributing to the cost. MAXIS will disregard the ineligible student's share of the costs.

2. Allow the remainder of the costs as a deduction.

The utility costs are not prorated. See [0018.15.09 \(Utility Deductions\)](#).

- For units which contain an ineligible unit member disqualified for intentional program violation or non-compliance with work requirements, allow the entire unit's applicable deduction amount, including the disqualified unit member.

Housing Costs Paid by People Living in the Home

If the SNAP unit is sharing housing costs with others living in their home, use the guidance below to determine what shelter cost the SNAP unit is eligible for as a deduction.

- If the SNAP unit has a lease agreement, mortgage statement or other official living agreement and has other people living with them, not in their SNAP unit, they are allowed the full lease amount, mortgage statement or living agreement as a shelter deduction. If the other people living there have an agreement to pay the SNAP unit housing costs, that money is counted as unearned income to the SNAP unit. In addition, if the other party paying the SNAP unit applies for SNAP themselves, what they are paying the other SNAP unit for housing costs can be allowed as a deduction. See [0017.15.33.27 \(Self-Employment Income From Roomer/Boarder\)](#).
- If the SNAP unit has a lease agreement, mortgage statement or other living agreement that lists the person/people not in the SNAP unit, then only allow the amount the SNAP unit is paying as part of their agreement as a shelter deduction.

Housing Costs Paid by People Not Living in the Home

If a 3rd party that is not living with the client is providing funds directly to the client for their housing costs, allow the deduction. These payments are counted as unearned income. If the 3rd party is paying the housing costs to the landlord/owner, this is not counted as income and the unit is not allowed the housing costs as a deduction unless the shelter expenses are paid by initial refugee funds or match grant. Shelter expenses paid by initial refugee funds must be allowed as a deduction for SNAP. See [0029.39 \(The Matching Grant Program\)](#), [0030.01 \(Local Resettlement Agencies\)](#).

If a unit receives subsidized housing, only allow what the client is actually paying for their shelter costs as a deduction.

Group Residential Housing (GRH)

When a unit resides in a GRH setting their deduction depends on the setting and the client's obligation:

- When the unit resides in a Group Supportive Housing, allow the client's obligation as the shelter deduction.
- When the unit resides in a Community Setting, first determine the client's monthly rental amount and their obligation.
 - When the client's obligation is less than the monthly rental amount, allow the client's obligation as a shelter deduction.
 - When the client's obligation is more than the monthly rental amount, allow the monthly rental amount as a deduction.

See the [Housing Support Setting Characteristics \(DHS-8292-ENG\)](#) for more information on Group Supportive Housing and Community Settings.

Maximum Shelter Costs

Once a unit verifies their shelter costs, they are allowed their adjusted shelter costs as a deduction, up to a maximum amount. Adjusted shelter costs are the unit's allowable housing costs plus their standard utility allowance minus 50% of the unit's net income. If the unit's adjusted shelter costs exceed the maximum amount, then they are allowed the maximum amount as a deduction. Currently, the maximum amount is **\$744**. MAXIS calculates the shelter deduction in the SNAP budget based on information entered on the appropriate panels. SNAP units with an elderly or disabled member are allowed their adjusted shelter costs as a deduction even when it is less than or exceeds the maximum amount. Elderly means someone who is age 60 years or older. See listed items under category 1 for disability determination in [0010.18.06 \(Verifying Disability/Incapacity – SNAP\)](#).

For allowable shelter deductions for Uncle Harry cases, see [0022.24 \(Uncle Harry Food Support Benefits\)](#).

Homeless Shelter Deduction

A homeless shelter deduction amount of **\$198.99** must be allowed for homeless SNAP units if they meet certain criteria outlined below. This amount is to be deducted from the unit's net income.

A unit is allowed the homeless shelter deduction if they meet ALL of the following:

- All individuals in the unit must be homeless. See [0002.29 \(Glossary: Gross RSDI\)](#) .
- The unit must be incurring a verified shelter cost. For verification of shelter deductions, see [0010.18.02.03 \(Non-Mandatory Verifications – SNAP\)](#). If the homeless SNAP unit cannot readily obtain traditional types of verification, take a verbal statement from the client if it is reasonable and do not obtain further verification(s).
- The homeless shelter deduction amount must be more than the unit's adjusted shelter costs. To calculate adjusted shelter costs:
 1. Add together the unit's verified housing costs = applicable utility standard. This is the unit's total shelter costs.
 2. Determine the unit's net income. See [0018 \(Determining Net Income\)](#).
 3. Subtract 50% of the units (rounded) net income from total shelter costs.

A unit allowed the homeless shelter deduction is not eligible for additional deduction for housing costs or a standard utility deduction as outline in [0018.15.09 \(Utility Deduction\)](#).

If the unit does not meet all of the criteria listed above, they should not be allowed the homeless shelter deduction and must be allowed a shelter deduction based on actual verified costs and applicable standard utility deduction. See [0018.15.09 \(Utility Deductions\)](#).

For more information on how to apply this deduction in MAXIS, see TE02.08.196 (SNAP Homeless Shelter Deduction).

Changes in Housing Costs

For changes in housing costs during the certification period, see [0008.06.01 \(Implementing Changes – Program Provisions\)](#).

UTILITY DEDUCTIONS

0018.15.09

MFIP, MSA, GA, GRH:

No provisions.

DWP:

Allow actual verified utility expenses and the flat rate of \$35 for telephone service, if applicable, in determining the amount of the grant. See [0022.12 \(How to Calc. Benefit Level - MFIP/DWP/GA\)](#).

SNAP:

The utility expenses a unit is responsible for are part of the shelter deduction. All SNAP units that are responsible for utility expenses separate from any other shelter expenses, such as rent, are allowed 1 or more of the mandatory standard utility deductions. For self-employed persons also claiming utility expenses as a business expense, continue to allow the applicable standard utility deduction.

Never prorate a utility deduction.

ALLOWING UTILITY EXPENSES

Units can have either the heat/air standard utility deduction OR one or both of the electric and phone standard utility deduction(s) when they are not responsible for heating and/or cooling expenses.

A unit is responsible for a cooling expense if it must pay expenses for operating any type of air conditioning system AND there is a reasonable expectation the unit will use air conditioning at any point during the year. A unit is responsible for a heating expense if it must pay for operating any heating system AND there is a reasonable expectation the unit will use heat at any point during the year.

Allow the Heat/Air Standard Utility Deduction of **\$667** for units that meet one of the following criteria:

- Responsible for heating and/or cooling expenses. This includes units who pay for additional expenses outside of their main heating and/or cooling source (for example, a SNAP unit that has heat included in their rent expense but incurs an additional expense for use of a space heater).
- Shares heating and/or cooling expenses with a separate unit at their residence (no proration).
- Received Low Income Home Energy Assistance Program (LIHEAP) of more than \$20 any time in the past 12 months and anywhere in the United States, regardless of whether they incur expenses for heating and/or cooling.
- Share the expenses with an ineligible person (no proration).

For units who are not responsible for heating and/or cooling expenses:

- Allow the electric standard utility deduction of **\$235** per month for units that are responsible for an electricity expense.
- Allow the phone standard utility deduction of **\$62** per month for units that are responsible for a phone expense. The phone standard utility deduction is allowed for phone expenses when the unit is responsible to pay for service. This includes but is not limited to:
 - Cell phones (monthly billing, pre-paid minutes or dollar value, etc.).
 - Land lines
 - Telecommunications Relay Services (captioned, internet, speech-to-speech, TTY, video, etc.).
 - Voice Over Internet (VOIP, internet phone).
- If the unit is responsible for both electric and phone expenses, both standard utility deductions are allowed.

ADDITIONAL CONSIDERATIONS

- Allow the applicable standard utility deduction for a unit when expenses are paid by:

- Initial refugee resettlement funds See [0030.01 \(Local Resettlement Agencies\)](#)
- Matching Grant. See [0029.39 \(The Matching Grand Program\)](#)
- Low Income Home Energy Assistance Program (LIHEAP)
- Vendored public assistance benefits
- An outside source and the amount paid does not cover the full monthly utility expense and the client is responsible to pay the remaining

- Do not allow a standard utility deduction for units when:
 - An ineligible student is responsible to pay the utility expense
 - Utility expenses are paid entirely by someone outside the SNAP unit
 - The utility expenses are included as part of a shelter expense, such as rent
 - Utility expenses are reimbursed or paid entirely by sources outside the unit such as Housing Support, Housing and Urban Development (HUD), and Farmers Home Administration (FMHA) Rental Assistance Program. See [0017.15.81 \(Utility Payments\)](#).

CHANGES IN UTILITY EXPENSES

For changes in utility expenses during the certification period, see [0008.06.01 \(Implementing Changes – Program Provisions\)](#).

HOMELESS SNAP UNITS

If a SNAP unit is eligible for a homeless shelter deduction, do not apply a utility deduction during the timeframe the homeless shelter deduction is allowed. For more information on eligibility for a homeless shelter deduction, see [0018.15 \(Shelter Deductions\)](#).

MFIP, DWP, GA, GRH:
No provisions.

SNAP:
Apply a standard deduction that is 8.31% of the maximum monthly net adjusted income to the total earned or unearned income of each unit based on its size. The standard deduction should not be less than the current standard for a unit size of 1 and no more than the standard for a unit size of 6.

UNIT SIZE	AMOUNT
1	\$209
2	\$209
3	\$209
4	\$223
5	\$261
6 or more people	\$299

As of October 1, 2010 the standard deduction is indexed to inflation.

MSA:
Apply a standard disregard of \$20 to a client's earned or unearned income. If a client has both types of income, apply the disregard to unearned income first, any remainder to earned income.

When both spouses are clients who live together, apply the disregard only once to their combined income.

MFIP, DWP, GA, GRH:

Use the 130% Federal Poverty Guidelines listed below when determining the income amount for sponsors and their household size. See [0031.33 \(Sponsor Deeming\)](#).

SNAP:

For information about the Gross Income Test for elderly/disabled units, see [0019 \(Gross Income Test\)](#).

The 130% Federal Poverty Guidelines (FPG) must be used in the following situations:

- As the gross income test for non-categorically eligible units WITHOUT an eligible elderly or disabled unit member. To determine SNAP categorical eligibility/ineligibility, see [0013.06 \(SNAP Categorical Eligibility/Ineligibility\)](#).
- As the income threshold when determining if a sponsored non-citizen meets the indigent exemption criteria to be exempt from sponsor deeming. See [0031.33 \(Sponsor Deeming\)](#).
- As the gross monthly income limit deduction for the sponsor's unit size when calculating sponsor income deeming for a sponsored non-citizen. See [0031.33 \(Sponsor Deeming\)](#).
- Six-Month Reporters must report when their gross income exceeds 130% FPG for the unit size. See [0007.03.02 \(Six-Month Reporting\)](#) for more information.

UNIT SIZE	130% FPG Income Limits
1	\$1,696
2	\$2,292
3	\$2,888
4	\$3,483
5	\$4,079
6	\$4,675
7	\$5,271
8	\$5,867
Each add'l member	\$596

The 200% FPG must be used as the gross income test for Broad Based Categorically Eligible (BBCE) units. To determine SNAP categorical eligibility/ineligibility, see [0013.06 \(SNAP Categorical Eligibility/Ineligibility\)](#).

Use the gross income limits below for categorically eligible SNAP units.

UNIT SIZE	200% FPG Income Limits
1	\$2,609
2	\$3,525
3	\$4,442
4	\$5,359
5	\$6,275
6	\$7,192
7	\$8,109
8	\$9,025
9	\$9,942
10	\$10,859
Each add'l member	\$917

NOTE: Units with an eligible elderly or disabled unit member with income above 200% FPG are non-categorically eligible and must meet the 100% net income test. See [0020.12 \(SNAP Assistance Standards\)](#).

MSA:

The gross income limit is 300% of the SSI Federal Benefit Rate (FBR) for an individual. See [0029.06.03 \(Supplemental Security Income Program\)](#) for the current rate.

If a married couple lives together and both partners apply and have a basis of eligibility, use their combined gross income. Their combined gross income must not exceed 600% of the SSI FBR for an individual.

MFIP, DWP, MSA, GA, GRH:
No provisions.

SNAP:
Disabled people who are 60 or older, and are unable to buy and prepare food separately, have the option of certification with the unit they would ordinarily be in, or forming a separate unit with their spouse. To be certified separately, the gross income of people remaining in the non-elderly/disabled unit cannot exceed these limits:

PEOPLE REMAINING IN THE UNIT	INCOME LIMITS (165% of FPG)
1	\$2,152
2	\$2,909
3	\$3,665
4	\$4,421
5	\$5,177
6	\$5,934
7	\$6,690
8	\$7,446
Each add'l member	\$757

Also see [0012.15 \(Incapacity and Disability Determinations\)](#), [0014 \(Assistance Units\)](#).

For gross income test (GIT) limits for categorical eligible units and non-categorical eligible units, see [0019.06 \(Gross Income Limits\)](#).

To determine whether a unit is categorically eligible, see [0013.06 \(SNAP Categorical Eligibility/Ineligibility\)](#).

MFIP:

FAMILY WAGE LEVEL -----TRANSITIONAL STANDARD-----

# Eligible People		Full Standard	Cash Portion	Food Portion
1	\$746	\$678	\$431	\$247
2	\$1,225	\$1,114	\$661	\$453
3	\$1,573	\$1,430	\$778	\$652
4	\$1,887	\$1,715	\$886	\$829
5	\$2,180	\$1,982	\$980	\$1,002
6	\$2,527	\$2,297	\$1,073	\$1,224
7	\$2,750	\$2,500	\$1,167	\$1,333
8	\$3,035	\$2,759	\$1,249	\$1,510
9	\$3,317	\$3,015	\$1,327	\$1,688
10	\$3,592	\$3,265	\$1,396	\$1,869
Each add'l person	\$272	\$248	\$66	\$182

Use the Family Wage Level (FWL) standard for all applicants at the initial income test.

When calculating the monthly benefit level, use the FWL only for units with earned income. See [0022.12 \(How to Calc. Benefit Level - MFIP/DWP/GA\)](#).

Some state and federal programs do not count the food portion as income. Examples of these programs include housing subsidy programs, low income energy assistance program, and Supplemental Security Income when determining interim assistance amount.

DWP:

Follow the CASH portion of the MFIP Transitional Standard. The maximum monthly benefit amount available under DWP is the difference between the unit's needs and the unit's countable income, not to exceed the cash portion of the MFIP standard of need.

SNAP, MSA, GA, GRH:

No provisions.

MFIP, DWP, MSA, GA, GRH:
No provisions.

SNAP:
Determine the proper assistance standard based on the size of the unit. When determining unit size, use the number of people in the unit in the payment month. See [0014 \(Assistance Units\)](#). Use the table below to determine the net income limit for the unit. Also see [0019.06 \(Gross Income Limits\)](#).

Non-categorically eligible units with an eligible elderly or disabled unit member, must have enough deductions to be at or below the 100% FPG limits below. This includes units with an eligible elderly or disabled unit member with income above 200% FPG. For the 200% FPG table, see [0019.06 \(Gross Income Limits\)](#).

UNIT SIZE	ASSISTANCE STANDARD (100% of Federal Poverty Guidelines (FPG))
1	\$1,305
2	\$1,763
3	\$2,221
4	\$2,680
5	\$3,138
6	\$3,596
7	\$4,055
8	\$4,513
Each add'l member	\$459

To determine how to calculate the benefit level, see [0022.12.01 \(How to Calculate Benefit Level - SNAP/MSA/GRH\)](#).

MFIP, DWP, SNAP, MSA, GRH:
No provisions.

GA:
People who live in a licensed residential facility, receive Housing Support, or receive substance use disorder treatment services are eligible for the GA personal needs allowance. See [0020.24 \(Personal Needs Allowance\)](#), [0013.15.12 \(GA – Basis – Placement in a Facility\)](#), and [0013.15.54 \(GA Basis – Drug/Alcohol Addiction\)](#).

Pay the personal needs allowance to the client or their authorized representative.

Residents of homeless or family violence shelters, and people with drug or alcohol addiction who live in the community and are not receiving substance use disorder treatment services, are eligible for the full GA basic needs standards. See [0013.15.54 \(GA Basis – Drug/Alcohol Addiction\)](#).

All other GA recipients are eligible for the full GA basic needs standard:

ELIGIBLE PEOPLE	MONTHLY STANDARD
One adult living alone	\$360.50
One adult living with parent(s) or an ineligible spouse	\$360.50
Minor or emancipated child not living with parent, stepparent, or legal custodian	\$360.50
Married couple with no children	Each eligible unit member receives \$360.50

MFIP, DWP, GA:

See [0022.12 \(How to Calc. Benefit Level - MFIP/DWP/GA\)](#).

SNAP:

Determine the benefit level as follows:

1. Subtract 30% of the unit's net adjusted income from the Thrifty Food Plan amount. Truncate any cents.

THRIFTY FOOD PLAN VALUES**UNIT SIZE BENEFIT AMOUNT**

1	\$298
2	\$546
3	\$785
4	\$994
5	\$1,183
6	\$1,421
7	\$1,571
8	\$1,789

For each additional member, add \$218

2. For applicants and units whose case is reinstated due to a break in eligibility of less than a month, prorate the benefit. See [0022.12.03 \(Proration\)](#).
3. Subtract recoupment amounts. See [0025.21.15 \(Recoupment\)](#).

The minimum SNAP allotment is \$24 for 1- and 2-person units.

For units in the 1st month of certification, issue benefits which are less than \$10 solely because of recoupment. If the benefit is less than \$10 for any other reason, issue \$0, but do not deny the application.

After the 1st month:

- If 1- or 2-member units are eligible for less than \$24 in monthly SNAP, issue \$24 unless there is an overpayment which you are recouping.
- Issue SNAP monthly benefits to units of 3 or more members even if the amount is less than \$24.

A unit of 3 or more people may pass the gross income test and meet net income limits but be eligible for \$0 in benefits. For these units, approve the application or keep the ongoing case open.

Also see [0024.03.03 \(When Benefits Are Paid - SNAP/MSA/GA/GRH\)](#), [0024.04 \(How Benefits Are Paid\)](#).

MSA:

Follow the procedures below to determine the benefit level.

FOR SSI RECIPIENTS

1. Subtract \$20 dollars from the client's SSI FBR. For information about the SSI Federal Benefit Rate (FBR), see [0029.06.03 \(Supplemental Security Income Program\)](#). Do NOT allow the \$20 disregard for residents of a long term care facility for which MA pays their cost of care. Do not make any adjustments due to other income the client may have (SSA has already adjusted the SSI payment).
2. Locate the appropriate standard in [0020.21 \(MSA Assistance Standards\)](#). Add any special need items the client is eligible for. See [0023 \(Special Needs Payments\)](#).
3. Subtract the result of Step 1 from the result of Step 2. The difference is the MSA benefit for the month. In the case of a married couple where BOTH partners have a basis of eligibility, divide the total by 2 to determine the benefit amount for each partner.
4. Determine if there is a recoupable amount. If there is, subtract the recoupment. See [0025.21.15 \(Recoupment\)](#).

FOR NON-SSI RECIPIENTS

1. Locate the appropriate assistance standard in [0020.21 \(MSA Assistance Standards\)](#). Add any special need items the client is eligible for in [0023 \(Special Needs Payments\)](#).
2. Subtract the client's net income from the result of Step 1. See [0018 \(Determining Net Income\)](#). The difference is the benefit for that month. In the case of an eligible married couple where BOTH partners are on MSA, divide the difference by 2 to determine the benefit amount for each partner.
3. Determine if there is a recoupable amount. If there is, subtract the recoupment. See [0025.21.15 \(Recoupment\)](#).

GRH:

Subtract net income in the budget month from the assistance standard for the corresponding payment month. NOTE: For the month the client enters the GRH setting, subtract ONLY the income that is actually available for that month. See [0018 \(Determining Net Income\)](#).

The assistance standard for a GRH client is the GRH rate specified on the MAXIS MONY/VND2 panel plus the difficulty of care amount specified on the MAXIS STAT/FACI panel for clients in adult foster homes without other service funding. See [0020.22 \(GRH Assistance Standards\)](#).

MFIP, DWP, SNAP, GA, GRH:

No provisions.

MSA:

A special need allowance for a special diet may be paid to MSA clients who are not residents of a nursing home, regional treatment center, or group residential housing facility.

Add an amount for special diet requirements to the monthly assistance standard. See below for the amount to add for a specific diet.

A licensed physician, advanced practice registered nurse, or physician assistant must prescribe the special diet(s). Verify the need at each recertification or more often if warranted. Do not require a unit to verify actual food expenditures. Another funding source must not be available to pay the diet costs.

The eligible diets and amounts are:

• Anti-dumping diet	\$44.70
• Controlled protein diet (40-60 grams and requires special products)	\$298.00
• Controlled protein diet (less than 40 grams and requires special products)	\$372.50
• Gluten free diet	\$74.50
• High protein diet (minimum 80 grams/day)	\$74.50
• High residue diet	\$59.60
• Hypoglycemic diet	\$44.70
• Ketogenic diet	\$74.50
• Lactose free diet	\$74.50
• Low cholesterol diet	\$74.50
• Pregnancy and lactation diet	\$104.30

When a client requests a payment for more than 1 diet, use the following guidelines to determine payment:

- If the recommended diets overlap one another with respect to their dietary components, allow the amount indicated for the more costly of the diets.
- If there is no overlap in the recommended dietary components of the prescribed diets, allow the total for all the prescribed diets.
- If a doctor prescribed diets which are mutually exclusive, do NOT allow either until adequate clarification has been received from the doctor who prescribed both diets.